7/22/2025

Head Start Supplemental Materials

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Executive Summary

2025 Community Needs Assessment Update
Portland Public Schools Early Learners Program

Children's Population

28,050
Children under age six in Portland

514,653
PPS district population (all ages)

~9,500
Children ages 3 & 4 PPS district

The PPS district represents 82% of Portland's population.

Sources: Early Learning Multnomah ECSA data 2022, PSU population data 2024, ACS 2019-2023

Where Head Start Eligible Families Live

Most eligible families live in outer northeast, outer southeast, and north Portland.

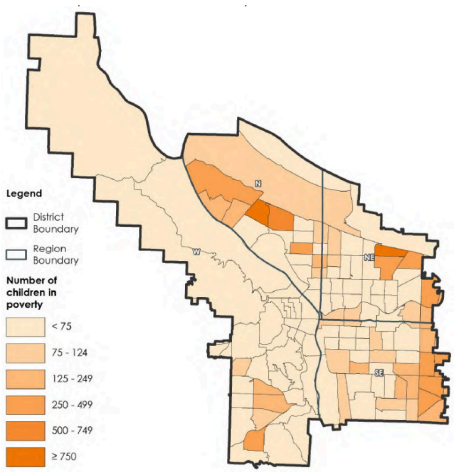


Figure 1: Population Under 18 in Portland Experiencing Poverty <100% Federal Poverty Level, 2018

Neighborhoods with the highest percentage of children experiencing poverty in the district are: St. Johns, Kenton, Cully, Madison South, Montavilla, and Lents.

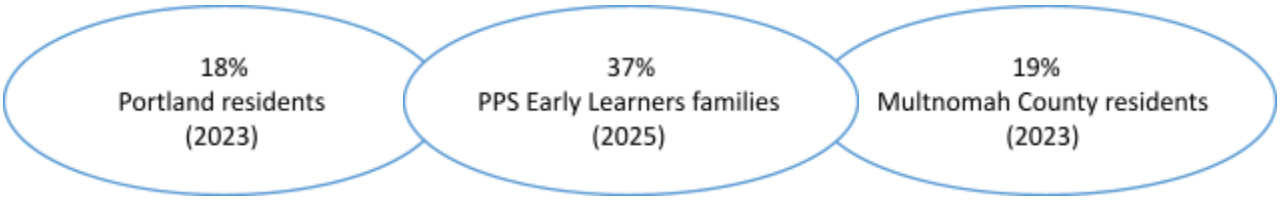
Source: District-Wide Baseline Assessment for Portland Public Schools, PSU and FLO Analytics, Census ACS 2013-2018 five-year estimates.

By neighborhood, there is a higher percentage of low-income households in Humboldt and Eliot (inner NE), St. Johns, North Piedmont, and Woodlawn (North), and Buckman, Hosford-Abernethy, Sellwood-Moreland, and Kerns (inner SE). *Source: city-data.com, 2023*

In 2023, more than 3,350 children under age six in Portland lived in households with income below federal poverty level – **a 50% increase since 2021.** The percentage of young children in households with income below 200% FPL increased from 21% to 24%.

Source: ACS, 2021 and 2023 one-year estimates, report B17024 and report DP03

Speaking a Language Other Than English at Home



Housing and Homelessness in Portland

- Portland median rent was $1,787 for a 2-bedroom – 26% higher than the average U.S. city (2023).
- About 1 in 30 Portland renters are evicted annually – some areas have rates as high as 1 in 15.
- In 2023-2024, there were 1,211 unhoused PPS K-12 students – a 54% increase since 2021-2022.
- **Approximately 200 preschoolers in the PPS district are experiencing homelessness.**

Availability of Child Care and ECE Programs – Multnomah County

From 2020-2022, Multnomah was one of six Oregon counties to double the number of child care slots for children ages 0-3. Still, **Multnomah County is a child care desert for infants and toddlers** – only one in five families has access to a regulated slot. *Source: OSU, Dec. 2022*

On the other hand, the county has adequate preschool options - 50% of children ages 3-5 had access to a regulated slot in 2022-2023.

Even with the recent expansion of 1,800 Preschool for All slots, Multnomah County needs an additional 3,995 preschool slots.

Source:Willamette Week, PFA presentation to county commissioners in fall 2024

11,427
Regulated Slots
3-5 year olds
(Spring 2023)

Early Learning Priority Populations – Multnomah County

Early Learning Multnomah (ELM) is the regional early childhood education hub.
The ELM Early Childhood Education Sector Plan (2020) lists three priority populations:

- Children ages birth to five from marginalized communities, including those who continue to be marginalized due to their race or immigrant and refugee status.
- Households with income below the county's Self Sufficiency Standard.
- Children with developmental delays and disabilities.

Health and Mental Health

The most notable recent health outcome is a 30% increase in the Multnomah County special education count for children under age six (2019-2023). Head Start staff confirmed this trend is happening in early learning programs statewide, and cited the need for more robust wraparound services in children and family health systems. Data in this report further underscores the need.

PreK Black Excellence Classroom

Comprehensive Plan



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ABOUT THE CLASSROOM



01

HISTORY OF PREK BLACK EXCELLENCE

FOUNDING OF PREK BLACK EXCELLENCE

The Black Excellence Classroom was initiated by the Equity Leadership Team in 2020–2021 to better serve Black students through a culturally-specific early learning model and received strong community support. Planning was paused to align with the launch of the Center for Black Student Excellence in 2022 and again following the unexpected passing of our lead teacher, Erica Jordan, in 2023. The effort resumed in 2024–2025, grounded in a renewed vision to honor her legacy and create a supportive, empowering space for young Black children and families.

GOALS OF THE CLASSROOM

The Black Excellence Classroom will empower families and educators to be equal partners as we build the necessary early literacy and numeracy foundation for later academic and socioemotional student success. The program will offer families and caregivers meaningful engagement opportunities within the classroom, as well as through out-of-school activities. Children and families will be welcomed, supported, celebrated, and seen as their whole selves. By centering both academic and cultural excellence, our classroom wil prepare students and families to navigate, succeed in, and positively impact every PPS school they enter.

Why PreK Black Excellence?

Center Black preschoolers in Portland by providing culturally responsive, affirming early learning experiences, especially in the historic Albina corridor.

Expand culturally-specific supports for Black families, including programs that reflect the heritage, values, and community strengths.

Ensure Black children are kindergarten-ready through high-quality early education aligned with P–3 systems and transitions.

Strengthen family engagement by honoring Black families as leaders in our children's education and partnering with community-rooted organizations.

Advance racial equity in early education by addressing disparities in access, discipline, and opportunity from the start.

Align with District equity initiatives by investing in culturally-specific strategies that close opportunity gaps and affirm Black excellence from day one.



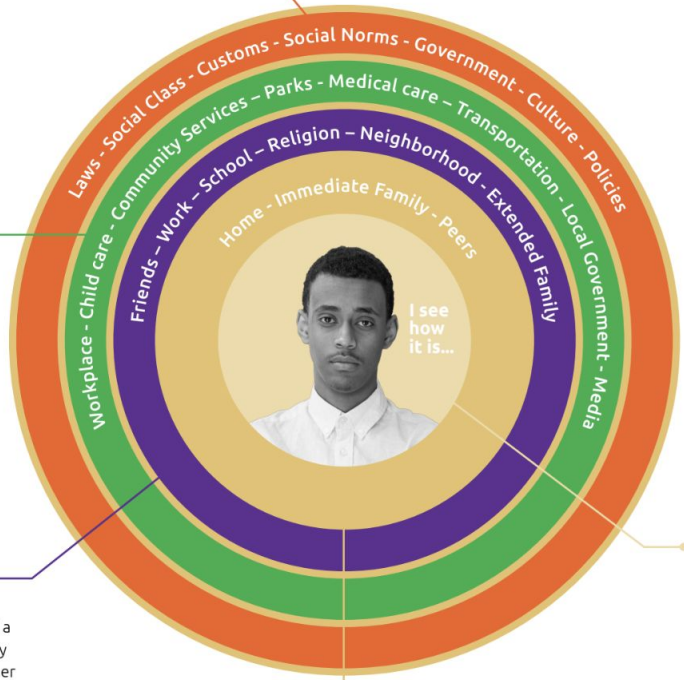


Black children are set up to fail from birth. *When will the healing begin?*

Color key
- Macrosystem
- Exosystem
- Mesosystem
- Microsystem
- Individual

MACROSYSTEM
Society, laws, customs, and policies are socially constructed to favor whiteness and justify racial oppression in the lie of Black inferiority. Government engages in financial disinvestment, negligence, and injustice in employment, housing, health care, law enforcement, land use, child welfare, transportation, and privatization of public services. Gentrification disrupts historically Black neighborhoods. Prisons serve as free labor.

EXOSYSTEM
Anti-Black messages are perpetuated in media. Black families work more hours and earn less. Schools lack sufficient resources. Affordable child-care centers are limited. Community services provided from deficit lens (reduce violence, increase academic achievement) that reinforces stereotypes. Bias of medical care providers contributes to health disparities. Absence or underfunding of community-based, culturally specific services. Limited access to safe, neighborhood parks. Over-reliance on public transportation.



MESOSYSTEM
Gang violence & peer victimization. Family dysfunction shuttles Black children toward a culturally deficit foster care system. Racially disproportionate health issues lead to higher death and infant mortality rates. Lack of connection to neighborhood and friends because of gentrification leads to depression and disconnection.

MICROSYSTEM
Race-based traumatic stress intensifies. Grief from repeated Black death. Poverty. Police bias. Family dysfunction breeds child abuse, sexual and physical abuse, and divorce. Neighborhoods lack safe places to play. Subconscious racial bias of white educators make schools "a site of Black suffering." School-to-prison pipeline.

INDIVIDUAL
Anti-Blackness organizes the social context of each Black child's life. Impacts: Prolonged grief, self-hatred, shame, hidden rage, aggression, helplessness, frustration. Unhealthy eating, sleep impairment, paranoia, alcohol & drug use, fatalism.

Here's what the research says works:

- Black children find meaning & belonging when engaged in creativity and interdepence.
- Black children need to build critical consciousness to understand how to navigate around the pro-White, anti-Black social systems designed to oppress them.
- Using storytelling, creativity, and naming of anti-Blackness provides necessary context for healing.

Source: Adopted from Bronfenbrenner, U. (1979) by Dr. S. Renee Mitchell (2021)

Further, Dr. Joy DeGruy, in her revised 2017 book, **"Post Traumatic Slave Syndrome – America's Legacy of Enduring Injury and Healing,"** defined maladaptive survival behaviors in African American communities throughout the United States and the Diaspora as a consequence of multigenerational oppression of Africans and their descendants resulting from centuries of chattel slavery, which was followed by generations of institutionalized racism. Under such persistently undermining circumstances, according to DeGruy, predictable negative behavior patterns form in Black children and adults, which include the lack of self-esteem, high risk of violence, and internalized racism (DeGruy, 2017). **These patterns have contributed to a re-emergence of community violence that has captured the attention of local and national news as gun-violence perpetrators are becoming younger. The epidemic of gun violence, as noted by the American Public Health Association, is the leading cause of premature death (Benjamin, 2015).**

And yet, insights from Black scholars echoed in decades-old research from the 1960s and beyond identify that there is potential progress if schools and society address the underlying issues that historically and consistently prevent Black students from achieving socially and academically. Similarly, for decades, Black scholars have pointed to healing practices as a key lever to reverse the effects of racialized trauma. *"This is a troublesome argument, touching as it does on a still unhealed part of American race relations," noted Claude M. Steele, in The Atlantic Online in April 1992. "But it leads us to a heartening principle: If blacks are made less racially vulnerable in school, they can overcome even substantial obstacles."*

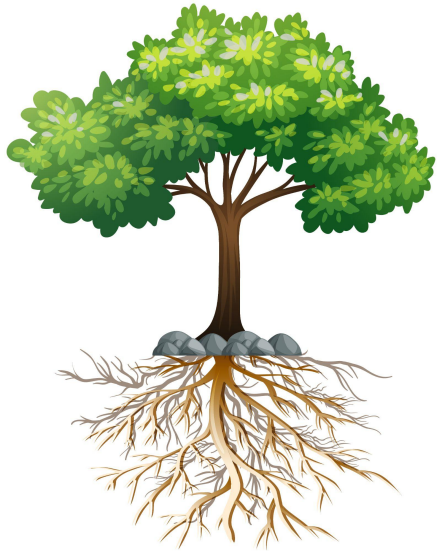
"BUT IT LEADS US TO A HEARTENING PRINCIPLE: IF BLACKS ARE MADE LESS RACIALLY VULNERABLE IN SCHOOL,THEY CAN OVERCOME EVEN SUBSTANTIAL OBSTACLES."

Each of these mentioned studies, in 1992, 2017, and 2021, confirm the need for schools and society to acknowledge and provide spiritual, psychological and social support for Black students, which research acknowledges as the most prodigiously traumatized adolescent group. Scholarly research also calls upon educators to support these youth to critically examine and reject racist, sexist ideals embedded in popular culture (Love, 2009). As the research surmises, youth must be rooted in a positive sense of self, empowered to advocate for themselves, and critique unjust systems while also cultivating opportunities to experience joy and healing. Additionally, as research positively connects play to learning, when we nourish liberatory spaces for Black youth to experience playfulness, it becomes a powerful way for them to radically heal from trauma, resist violence, and experience joy and liberation (Hill, 2021).



PREK BLACK EXCELLENCE DESIGN TEAM

Amber Brown
Alan Splitter
Aryn Frazier
Alessandro Williams
Ayla Terry-Mitchell*
Courtney Richardson*
Dana Stiles
Emily Glasgow*
Jacqueline Hall
Jason Roepel*
Karissa Palmer
Kenya Budd*
Lisa Joy Switalla
Mashari Tyson*
Nichole Watson
Rhiannon Martin
Sonya Davis
Sara Peloquin
Teresa-Marie Oller
Takiyah Williams
Vanessa Valdez



ABOUT THE DESIGN PROCESS

The PreK Black Excellence Classroom has been led and nurtured by Black staff since its inception. The Black Excellence Classroom Design Team, led by the Early Learners Engagement and Equity Coordinator, Crystal Ball, was established this school year in order to formalize our collaborative community and family partnerships.

The Design Team has representation from Black PPS preschool families, Center for Black Excellence, PPS Center for Black Student Excellence, Black Excellence Group, Preschool for All, Multnomah County Mental Health Consultation, PPS preschool educators, and the PPS Black Excellence Education and Early Learners Family Service team.

JOURNEY MAP

2020: Idea Proposed

2021: Gauged Parents & Community Interest

2022: Paused planning for anticipated opening of CBSE

2024: Resumed & Assembled Design Team

January 2024: Mission, Vision & Values

February 2025: Enrollment & Recruitment Flyer Design

April 2025: Curriculum Development & Class Design

May 2025: Themes & Classroom Design Integration

June 2025: Review Comprehensive Plan

October 2025: Ribbon Cutting Ceremony





VISION
MISSION
and VALUES

02





VISION

To advance a culture of Black excellence by unifying and elevating the Black educational experience, infused with joy, healing, and high expectations to improve outcomes and create transformative learning opportunities for Black students.

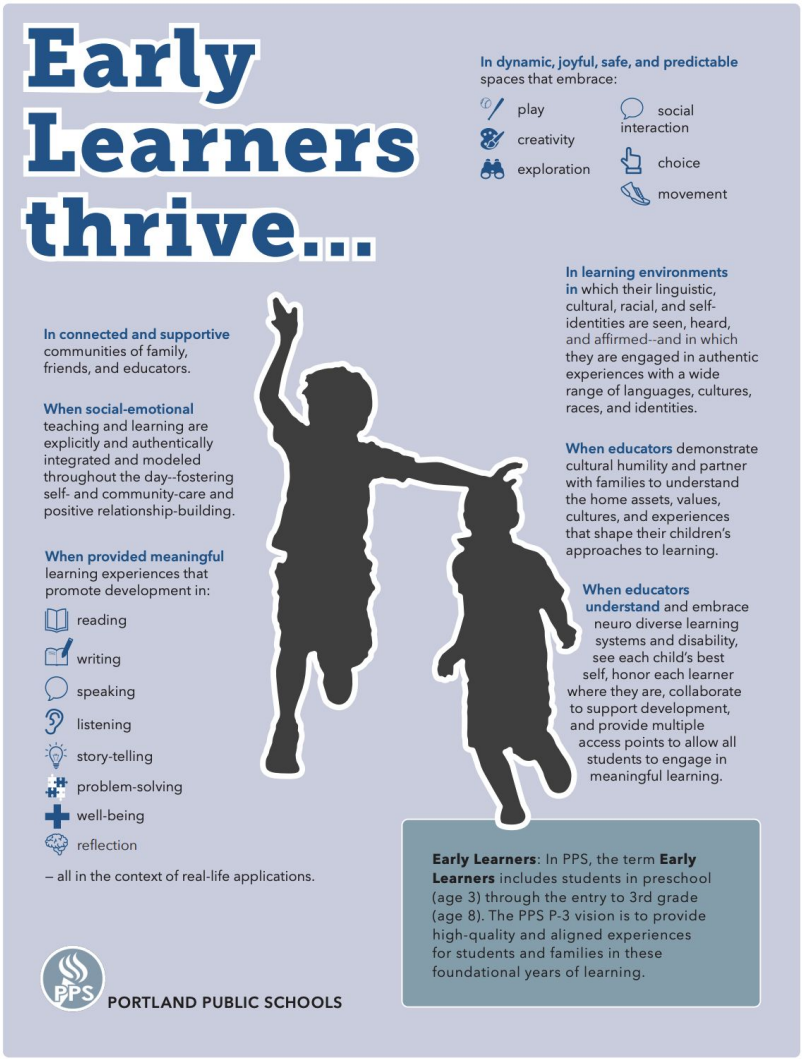
MISSION

We envision a future where Black students thrive in an educational system that is reimagined through their brilliance. Where they are seen, heard, and celebrated from preschool through graduation. Our vision is rooted in love, joy, academic excellence, and a deep commitment to healing the harm caused by systemic inequities.

VALUES

Every child can learn.
Every teacher can teach Black children.
Every family can support their children's success in school.
Every subject can be a source of joy for students.
Every experience can be honored and honed for student success.

Early Learners Core Values



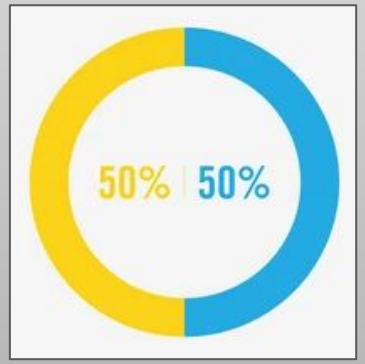


FAMILY and COMMUNITY PARTNERSHIP

03

FUNDING

STATE OPK	50%
PRESCHOOL FOR ALL	50%



The PreK Black Excellence classroom will be entirely grant-funded by Oregon Prenatal to Kindergarten and Preschool for All (Multnomah County funding). Interested families at all income levels will have access to the classroom.

Preference will be given to applicants in the following order:

- Returning children who will be in their final year of PreK enrollment
- Interested families whose first choice of school is Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr.
- All other interested families who fall into a priority population listed below

Head Start eligibility requirements:

- Less than 100% of federal poverty
- Currently experiencing homelessness
- Receiving Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF)
- Receiving Social Security Income (SSI) benefits
- Children who are in foster care
- Receiving Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) benefits

Preschool For All priority populations:

- Black, Brown, Native American Indigenous, and all Children of Color;
- Children who speak languages other than English;
- Children with developmental delays and disabilities;
- Children living in or at risk of placement in foster care;
- Children from families experiencing low incomes;
- Children experiencing homelessness.



RECRUITMENT & ENROLLMENT FOR SY24–25 (as of June 2025)

- Returners enrolled: 11
- New enrollments: 7

- 3-year olds: 5
- 4-year olds: 13

- Waitlist across program: 18+

DISTRICT & COMMUNITY PARTNERSHIPS

PreK Black Excellence classroom works in close partnership with district programs, departments, and community partners.

PPS Early Learners Department
PPS Center for Black Student Excellence
Center for Black Excellence
BE Group
Multnomah County Mental Health
Preschool For All

There are multiple opportunities for family partnership in the PreK Black Excellence classroom:

Our PreK program offers **wrap-around services to families** that include health, mental health, education, and engagement supports. Annually, families receive two homes visits with their Family Advocate, two conferences with the classroom teacher, and two home visits with the classroom team.

Our PreK sites have **family events and celebrations** over the course of the school year. Some events include monthly principal chats, OMSI play labs, parenting workshops, field trips, and cultural celebrations.

The classroom will participate in Black cultural celebrations that integrate storytelling, music, culture, and food of the diaspora. There will be an annual **Black History Month Celebration** and events throughout the year that celebrate and recognize the legacy and impact of local, historical, and current Black leaders.





INSTRUCTIONAL SUPPORT

04

INSTRUCTIONAL FRAMEWORK

The PreK Black Excellence classroom aligns to the PPS Educational Equity Framework. The program centers best practices for preschoolers.

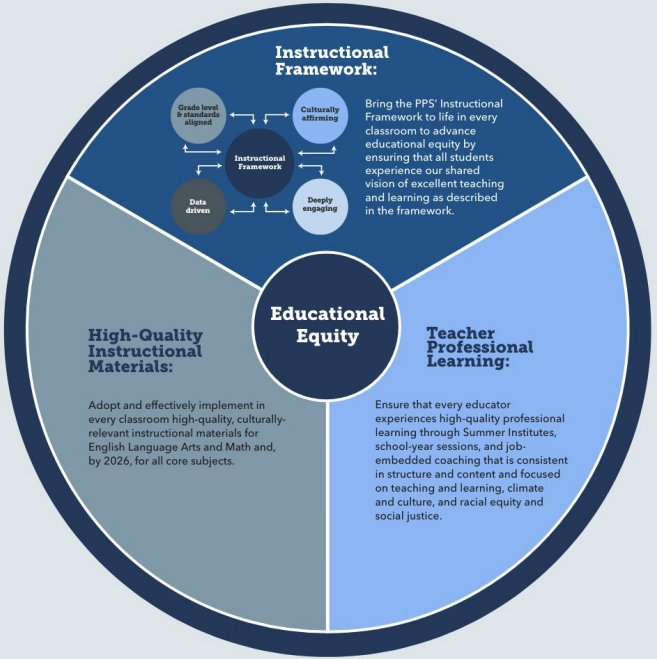
The PreK educator and educational assistants have access to:

- Curricular support and classroom coaching via an Early Learning Instructional Coach.
- Professional learning via Summer Institute, Professional Learning Communities, and professional development throughout the year.
- Wrap-around supports from Family Advocates and Mental Health Consultants.

Our Roadmap Toward Educational Equity for All PK-12 Students

PPS is committed to providing all students with high-quality teaching and learning in every classroom, every day - instruction that helps them achieve our Graduate Portrait and closes persistent gaps in outcomes based on race.

In partnership with teachers, school leaders, and staff from across the district, we're taking several important steps to make this vision a reality for all students: calibrating around a new instructional framework that articulates a shared vision of highly effective teaching and learning, adopting new curricula to support that instruction, and offering improved professional learning experiences for teachers aligned to both.



CLASSROOM MATERIALS

Book and Materials – in collaboration with teacher [in process]



Curriculum: **Tools of the Mind**

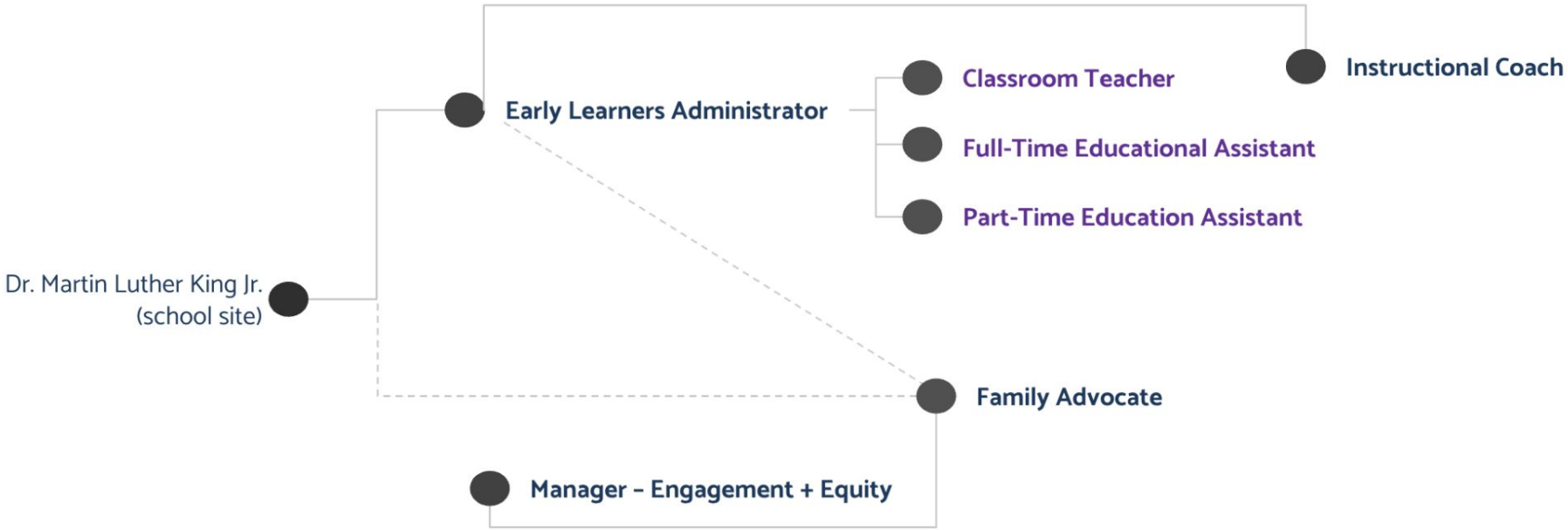
Supplemental Literacy Curriculum: **Heggerty**

Summative Assessment:

Desired Results Developmental Profile

In addition to culturally- and locally-relevant instructional materials, we will also work with parents and families to increase literacy at home through reading, song, oral history, and with community partners to embed additional out-of-school literacy opportunities that will propel their learning and ensure they are kindergarten ready.

CLASSROOM STAFFING STRUCTURE



CLASSROOM THEMES



FAMILY NEIGHBORHOOD



MEDICAL



GROCERY STORE RESTAURANT



PET VET



NATURE MAKERSPACE



OTHER IDEAS

Music, Art, Hair Salon, Zoo, Dance, Business, Dance, Juneteenth

CLASSROOM CENTERS

PPS PreK classrooms use a play-based, student led approach

Classroom centers include:

BLOCKS
DRAMATIC PLAY
TABLE TOYS
ART
LITERACY
SCIENCE









SAMPLE DAILY SCHEDULE

Arrival
Circle Time
Bathroom
Breakfast
Movement
Read Aloud
Scaffolded Writing
Play Block
Circle Time
Small Groups
→ Science
→ Math
→ Social Emotional
Bathroom
Large Motor
Lunch
Bathroom
Brush Teeth
Rest
Snack
Dismissal

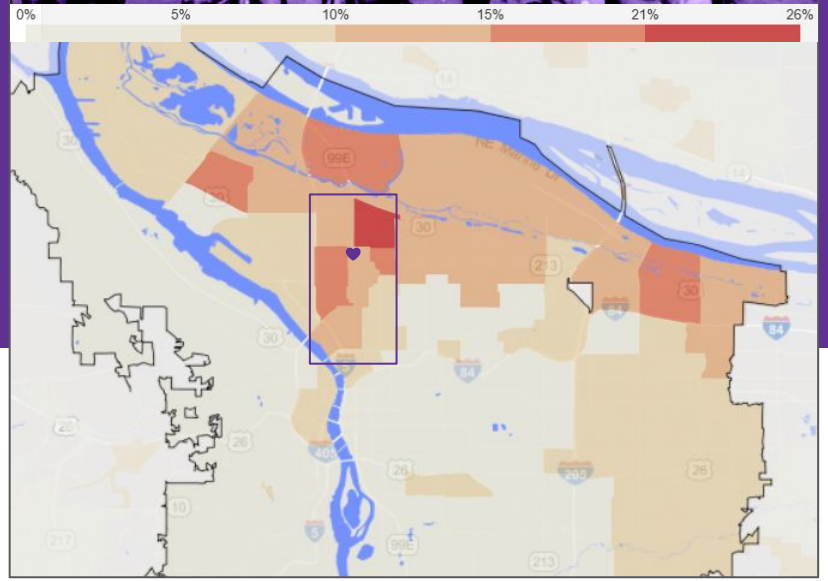
INSTRUCTIONAL DAY



CLASSROOM OPENING SY25–26

05





OUR CLASSROOM LOCATION

The classroom will be at Dr. Martin Luther King, Jr. Elementary School in NE Portland.

This decision was informed by ....

- Location of Black students & families
- Historical Albina Corridor
- Community support & resources
- Dr. King as a legacy school

Graphic from Coalition of Communities of Color-Statistical Atlas

THE CLASSROOM TEAM

TEACHER	Takiyah Williams
FAMILY ADVOCATE	Courtney Richardson
FULL TIME EDUCATIONAL ASSISTANT	Jaci Hall
PART TIME EDUCATIONAL ASSISTANT	Joyce Richardson







THANK YOU!

Thank you to all involved in the project!

We are incredibly grateful for the hard work of the community on this project and excited for the future of the our Black students and families.

Parent Policy Council Agenda

4/16/2025
Early Learners at MLK Annex
5:15 to 7:00pm

Info	Region X office closure-follow up ● What is the Region X office? ● How can parents advocate? ● Will other services be impacted (ie. SNAP)? ○ Lots of conversation about what defines “equity or DEI”? ○ Discussion about contingency plans that were created to prepare for different scenarios Q & A - Add questions in chat, email prekprograms@pps.net, or submit through Google Form	Emily + Dana	30 min
Notes	Presentation Slides Highlights: ● Portland Public Schools will continue to prioritize the success and well-being of every student. ● We will communicate openly and honestly. If and when definitive changes occur that impact our students, staff, or families, we will share updates clearly and directly. ● Regional Head Start office closures do not impact our children, families or children directly. The regional office provides guidance and support for Head Start programs to meet Performance Standards. We are working to navigate changes in partnership with district, state, and county organizations. ● Recent directives that state federal funds cannot be used for anything related to Diversity, Equity and Inclusion has caused us to look at the language we use in our documents, specifically for our future grant application. Again, this directive does not change our values, services, and the assistance we provide to families remain the same.		

Call to order	Warm Welcome	Chair – Teresa/Alex	5 min
Info	Agenda Overview In Attendance: Teresa, Rhiannon, Dana, Elizabeth, Alex, Tess, Lindsey, Emily, Vanessa Hannah, Kelsey, Troy, Lauren, Katherine	Chair – Teresa/Alex Dana to support	5 min
Action	Review and approve minutes from March Meeting Motion: Alex Second: Jenn Approved: 6 Opposed: 0	Secretary – Lauren Dana to support	10 min
Action	Review and Approve Director's Report Motioned: Lauren Second: Elizabeth Approved:8 Opposed: 0	Dana	15 min
Action	Review and Approve Treasurer's Report Jenn motions to approve/ Tess seconds Approved:7 Opposed:0	Treasurer – Kara Nancy to support	10 min
Action	Staff Appreciation Funds: use for Staff Wellness Fair, $600 from Teacher Appreciation line item Elizabeth Motioned to approve/ Lauren seconds Approved:8 Opposed: 0		
Info	Clothing Swap ● Faubion: Completed March 18th ○ Planned for 1 day, but lasted 3 days by popular demand ○ Support with drop off and pick up and play dates as well ○ Discussed how to improve family engagement ○ More flyers and communication from teachers and FAs. ○ Next swap is early May. ● Kelly Center Communications: ● Discussion about timely outreach/communications for DLI programs and TAG programs ● Discussion about creating a timeline to share with families for different program options throughout the year		10 min
Action	Next meeting location: King?	Chair – Teresa/Alex	

Notes:	• Lauren writes a letter to the Director of Communication with Parent Policy Council feedback regarding Remind App.		
Adjourn		Chair – Teresa/Alex	
Next Meeting on Wednesday, May 14, 5:00pm Location: Dr. MLK Jr Annex-4803 NE 7th Ave			

Agenda del Consejo de Políticas de Padres

4/16/2025
Early Learners at MLK Annex
5:15 to 7:00pm

Información	Cierre de la oficina de la Región X: seguimiento • ¿Qué es la oficina de la Región X? • ¿Cómo pueden los padres abogar por sus hijos? • ¿Se verán afectados otros servicios (p. ej., SNAP)? Preguntas y respuestas: Agregue sus preguntas en el chat, envíe un correo electrónico a PreKPrograms@pps.net o envíelas a través del formulario de Google.	Emily + Dana	30 min
Notas	Presentation Slides • Las Escuelas Públicas de Portland seguirán priorizando el éxito y el bienestar de cada estudiante. • Nos comunicaremos de forma abierta y honesta. Si se producen cambios definitivos que afecten a nuestros estudiantes, personal o familias, compartiremos las actualizaciones de forma clara y directa. • El cierre de las oficinas regionales de Head Start no afecta directamente a nuestros niños, familias ni a nuestros hijos. La oficina regional proporciona orientación y apoyo para que los programas Head Start cumplan con los Estándares de Desempeño. Estamos trabajando para gestionar los cambios en colaboración con organizaciones del distrito, estatales y del condado. • Las recientes directivas que prohíben el uso de fondos federales estatales para fines		

	relacionados con la Diversidad, la Equidad y la Inclusión nos han obligado a revisar el lenguaje que utilizamos en nuestros documentos, especialmente para nuestra futura solicitud de subvención. Cabe destacar que esta directiva no cambia nuestros valores, servicios y la asistencia que brindamos a las familias sigue siendo la misma.		
Llamar al orden	Cálida bienvenida	Presidente – Teresa/Alex	5 min
Información	Descripción general de la agenda En asistencia: Teresa, Rhiannon, Dana, Elizabeth, Alex, Tess, Lindsey, Emily, Vanessa Hannah, Kelsey, Troy, Lauren, Katherine	Presidente – Teresa/Alex Dana para apoyar	5 min
Acción	Revisar y aprobar los minutos de la reunión de Marzo Moción: Alex Segunda: Jenn Aprobado: 6 Opuesto: 0	Secretaria – Lauren Dana para apoyar	10 min
Acción	Revisar y aprobar el informe del director Moción: Lauren Segunda: Elizabeth Aprobado: 8 Opuesto: 0	Dana	15 min
Acción	Revisar y aprobar Informe del tesorero Moción: Jenn Segunda: Tess Aprobado: 8 Opuesto: 0	Tesorero – Kara Nancy para apoyar	10 min
Acción	Fondos de reconocimiento al personal: uso para la Feria de bienestar del personal Moción: Elizabeth Segnunda: Lauren Aprobado: 8 Opuesto: 0		
Información	Intercambio de ropa ● Faubion ○ Planeado para un día, pero duró 3 días por demanda popular. ○ Apoyo con la entrega y recogida de niños y citas para jugar. ○ Se discutió cómo mejorar la participación familiar. ○ Más folletos y comunicación de maestros y asistentes familiares. ○ El próximo intercambio es a principios de mayo. ● Kelly Center		10 min
Notas	● Lauren escribe una carta al Director de Comunicación con comentarios del Consejo de Políticas de Padres sobre la aplicación Remind.		

Acción	¿Lugar de la próxima reunión? ¿King?	Presidente – Teresa/Alex	
Aplazar		Presidente – Teresa/Alex	
Próxima reunión el 14 de Mayo a las 17:00 horas Ubicación: Dr. MLK Jr Annex-4803 NE 7th Ave			

PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

Parent Policy Council Minutes

5/14/2025
Early Learners at MLK Annex
5:15 to 7:00pm

Call to order	Warm Welcome:	Chair – Teresa/Alex	5 min
Info	Agenda Overview In Attendance: In person: Troy, Elizabeth, Dana, Rhiannon, Crystal, Vanessa, Maria, Kara, Alex, Jenn, Online: None	Chair – Teresa/Alex Dana to support	5 min
Action	Review and approve minutes from April Meeting Discussion and review about funding discussed from previous meeting: ● Regional office closed ● Restructure, now we are part of Headstart Region West ● Continue to use communications and contracts as usual ● Seeking DEI clarity for grants applications etc. ● Working with Chief Communication Officer to determine next steps for language ● Still working on contingency plans to prepare for different scenarios ● Spending freeze to build emergency fund for next year as needed ● Feeling optimistic about headstart funding moving forward. ● Review letter to Director of Communications with feedback about the Remind App Motion: Alex Second: Elizabeth Approved: 6 Opposed: 0	Secretary – Lauren Dana to support	10 min

Action	Review and Approve Director's Report ● Discussion around health data/mental health data and how we can support parents and families to positively impact student behaviors. ○ Offer parenting classes to parents over the summer to help with school transitions. ○ More intentional classes and additional support for next year for mental health. Motion: Lauren Second: Jenn Approved: 6 Opposed: 0	Dana	15 min
Action	Review and Approve Treasurer's Report ● Discussion around how to find an alternative to Amazon for classroom purchases ● Talked about purchase policy. ● Storage inventory checked before large purchases. ● Idea to give teacher $25 per classroom to fund end of year celebrations ○ Motion: Elizabeth ○ Second: Jenn ○ Approved: 6 ○ Opposed: ● Proposal for costco line item in the policy council budget ○ More discussion next month ○ Propose and vote on it next month Motion: Lauren Second: Alex Approved: 6 Opposed: 0	Treasurer – Kara Nancy to support	10 min
Action	Policy Approvals (All newly worded policies – please review): ● Safety Practices ● Active Supervision ● Parent Activities ● Classroom Coaching ● Fees ● Staff Training and Professional Development Motion: Lauren	Rhiannon/Dana	15 min

	Second: Troy Approved: 6 Opposed: 0		
Info			10 min
Action	Next meeting location: King?	Chair – Teresa/Alex	
Adjourn		Chair – Teresa/Alex	
Next Meeting on Wednesday, June 4, 5:15pm Location: TBD			

Actas del Consejo de Políticas de Padres

5/14/2025
Estudiantes de primera infancia en el Anexo MLK
17:15 a 19:00

Llamar al orden	Cálida bienvenida:	Presidenta – Teresa/Alex	5 min
Información	Descripción general de la agenda Presentes: En persona: Troy, Elizabeth, Dana, Rhiannon, Crystal, Vanessa, Maria, Kara, Alex, Jenn, En línea: Ninguno	Presidenta – Teresa/Alex Dana para apoyar	5 min
Acción	Revisar y aprobar las actas de la reunión de abril Discusión y revisión sobre la financiación discutida en la reunión anterior: ● Oficina regional cerrada ● Reestructuración, ahora somos parte de Headstart Región Oeste ● Continuar utilizando las comunicaciones y los contratos como de costumbre. ● Buscando claridad de DEI para solicitudes de subvenciones, etc. ● Trabajar con el director de comunicaciones para determinar los próximos pasos en materia de idiomas ● Todavía estamos trabajando en planes de contingencia para prepararnos para diferentes escenarios. ● Congelación del gasto para crear un fondo de emergencia para el próximo año según sea necesario ● Me siento optimista acerca de la financiación inicial en el futuro. ● Carta de revisión al Director de Comunicaciones con comentarios sobre la aplicación Remind Moción: Alex Segundo: Isabel	Secretaria – Lauren dana para apoyar	10 min

	Aprobado: 6 Opuesto: 0		
Acción	Revisar y aprobar el informe del director ● Discusión sobre datos de salud/datos de salud mental y cómo podemos apoyar a los padres y familias para impactar positivamente el comportamiento de los estudiantes. ○ Ofrecer clases para padres durante el verano para ayudarlos con las transiciones escolares. ○ Más clases intencionales y apoyo adicional para el próximo año para la salud mental. Moción: Lauren Segundo: Jenn Aprobados: 6 Opuestos: 0	Dana	15 min
Acción	Revisar y aprobar Informe del Tesorero ● Debate sobre cómo encontrar una alternativa a Amazon para las compras en las aulas ● Habló sobre la política de compras. ● Inventario de almacenamiento revisado antes de compras grandes. ● Idea de darle a los maestros $25 por salón para financiar las celebraciones de fin de año ○ Moción: Elizabeth ○ Segundo: Jenn ○ Aprobados: 6 ○ Opuesto: ● Propuesta para una partida de Costco en el presupuesto del consejo de políticas ○ Más discusión el próximo mes ○ Proponlo y votalo el próximo mes. Moción: Lauren Segundo: Álex Aprobado: 6 Opuestos: 0	Tesorero – Kara Nancy para apoyar	10 min
Acción	Aprobaciones de políticas (Todas las políticas recientemente redactadas; revíselas): ● Prácticas de seguridad	Rhiannon/Dana	15 min

	• Supervisión activa • Actividades para padres • Entrenamiento en el aula • Honorarios • Capacitación del personal y desarrollo profesional Movimiento: Lauren Segundo: Troya Aprobados: 6 Opuestos: 0		
Información			10 min
Acción	Lugar de la próxima reunión: ¿Rey?	Presidenta – Teresa/Alex	
Aplazar		Presidenta – Teresa/Alex	
Próxima reunión el miércoles 4 de junio a las 17:15 horas. Ubicación: por determinar			

PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

Parent Policy Council Agenda

6/4/2025
Early Learners at MLK Annex
5:15 to 7:00pm

Call to order	Warm Welcome	Chair – Teresa/Alex	5 min
Info	Agenda Overview In Attendance: In Person: Alex, Jenn, Troy, Elizabeth Online: NA	Chair – Teresa/Alex Dana to support	5 min
Action	Review and approve minutes from May Meeting Discussion: minutes reviewed, no questions or comments Motion: Second: Approved: Opposed:	Secretary – Lauren Dana to support	10 min
Action	Review and Approve Director's Report ● Mental Health Data Discussion: discussed trends in Mental Health data shared, wondering how the data compares to other ECE programs in the area Motion: Second: Approved: Opposed:	Dana	15 min
Action	Review and Approve Treasurer's Report Discussion: report reviewed, no questions Motion: Second: Approved: Opposed:	Treasurer – Kara Nancy to support	10 min
Info	2025-26 Budget Planning Discussion: shared where program is at currently, some unknowns moving into next year, no firm budget to approve-program will send out budget once ready for vote over the summer	Dana	10 min

	Ideas from parents: ● Movement activities ● Hands-on projects for children ● Gardening projects ● Art enrichment		
Info	Final Enrollment Email Feedback ● Family Welcome Packet Discussion: edit for fewer words, helpful information, send through Smore to support translation for all families	Rhiannon	10 min
Info	Remind update ● District is moving to ParentSquare over the summer, details not available yet	Rhiannon/Vanessa	5 min
Adjourn		Chair – Teresa/Alex	
Happy Summer!			

Agenda del Consejo de Políticas de Padres

6/4/2025
Early Learners at MLK Annex
5:15 to 7:00pm

Llamar al orden	Cálida bienvenida	Presidenta – Teresa/Alex	5 min
Información	Descripción general de la agenda En asistencia: Alex, Jenn, Troy, Elizabeth	Presidente – Teresa/Alex Dana para apoyar	5 min
Acción	Revisar y aprobar los minutos de la reunión de Mayo. Actas revisadas, sin preguntas ni comentarios	Secretaria – Lauren Dana para apoyar	10 min
Acción	Revisar y aprobar el informe del director ● Datos de salud mental Se discutieron las tendencias en los datos de salud mental compartidos y se preguntó cómo se comparan los datos con otros programas de ECE en el área.	Dana	15 min
Acción	Revisar y aprobar Informe del tesorera Informe revisado, sin preguntas	Tesorera – Kara Nancy para apoyar	10 min
Información	Planificación presupuestaria 2025-26 Se compartió la situación actual del programa, algunas incógnitas para el próximo año, no hay un presupuesto firme para aprobar; el programa enviará el presupuesto una vez que esté listo para votación durante el verano.	Dana	10 min
Información	Correo electrónico de inscripción final: ¿Qué piensas? ● Family Welcome Packet Editar para reducir las palabras, información útil, enviar a través de Smore para apoyar la traducción para todas las familias	Rhiannon	10 min
Información	Recordar actualización ● El distrito se mudará a ParentSquare durante el verano; los detalles aún no están disponibles.	Rhiannon/Vanessa	5 min
Aplazar		Presidenta – Teresa/Alex	

¡Feliz verano!

PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

HEAD START

4800 NE 74th Ave/ Portland, OR 97218

Telephone: (503) 916-5724

MEMO

Date: 07/08/2025

To: PPS School Board

From: Emily Glasgow, Senior Director of PK-5 Core Academics
Dana Stiles, Director of Early Learners (Head Start)

Subject: Head Start Action and Informational Items

BACKGROUND

A. Federal requirements call for the Governing Board of Head Start to approve recommendations and reports for the program.

B. The Board of Directors for Portland Public Schools serves as the Governing Board for PPS Head Start.

1. Updated Policy & Procedures

1.A. Safety Practices – PPS Early Learners (Head Start) has revised the Safety Practices Policy in alignment with Head Start Performance Standards §1302.47(a)(4) Achieving program goals, §1302.47(b)(7)(iii) Safety Practices, and §1302.74(a) Safety Procedures. PPS Early Learners incorporates a system of health and safety practices that ensures a safe, secure and healthy environment to support children's learning and development. PPS Early Learners Parent Policy Council approved this policy and procedure on May 14, 2025. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

1.B. Active Supervision – PPS Early Learners (Head Start) has revised the Active Supervision Policy in alignment with Head Start Performance Standards §1302.90 – Personnel policies. All staff and adults in our program are responsible for actively supervising children at all times in accordance with the program and district standards of conduct. PPS Early Learners Parent Policy Council approved this policy and procedure on May 14, 2025. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

1.C. Parent Activities – PPS Early Learners (Head Start) has revised the Parent Activities Policy in alignment with Head Start Performance Standards §1302.51 – parent activities to promote child learning and development. The program values parents as their child's first teacher and will work to promote shared responsibility with families for their children's early learning and development. PPS Early Learners Parent Policy Council approved this policy and procedure on May 14, 2025. Board approval of new

policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

1.D Classroom Coaching – PPS Early Learners (Head Start) has revised the Classroom Coaching Policy in alignment with Head Start Performance Standards §1302.92(c) – Training and professional development. The program implements a coordinated coaching plan for all education staff that assesses their strengths and needs and supports them in developing their skills and knowledge in order to provide high quality, comprehensive services to children and families. PPS Early Learners Parent Policy Council approved this policy and procedure on May 14, 2025. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

1.E. Fees – PPS Early Learners (Head Start) has revised the Fees Policy in alignment with Head Start Performance Standards §1302.18 – Fees. Our program provides comprehensive services to eligible children and families at no charge. We recognize that the need for early childhood services is often greatest among the priority populations, including children from low-income families, children with disabilities, and those facing other barriers to access. PPS Early Learners Parent Policy Council approved this policy and procedure on May 14, 2025. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

1.F Staff Training and Professional Development – PPS Early Learners (Head Start) has revised the Staff Training Policy in alignment with Head Start Performance Standards §1302.92(c) – Training and professional development. The program incorporates best practices for adult learners in our professional development to implement a systematic approach to staff training. Professional development includes onboarding, annual Preservice, regular training through the school year, and professional learning communities. PPS Early Learners Parent Policy Council approved this policy and procedure on May 14, 2025. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

2. Application for Federal Grant Renewal

Board approval is required to apply for continuation of federal grant funds ($6,382,217) for Fiscal Year 2026. The Head Start Parent Policy Council approved PPS Head Start applying for these funds on July 16, 2025. The application is due August 1, 2025. The Federal Funding Guidance Letter is attached. Board approval is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

3. 2024 – 2025 PreK Black Excellence Comprehensive Plan

The interest in opening a PreK Black Excellence Classroom began several years ago. PPS Early Learners Department put together an equity-centered Design Team to plan for the opening of a PreK Black Excellence Classroom for the 2025-26 school year. Led by Black PPS Early Learners staff, the Design Team was tasked with creating a comprehensive plan for the classroom that meets the needs of our students and the community; the plan considers mission/vision, curricular resources, community partnerships, and family engagement. The PreK Black Excellence Classroom will open at Dr. Martin Luther King Jr School in the fall fully enrolled. The PreK Black Excellence Comprehensive Plan is attached. This report is for the Governing Body's information only. Governing Body approval is not required.

4. 2025 Community Needs Assessment – Executive Summary

Head Start requires programs to conduct a full community assessment that uses data to describe the community strengths, needs, and resources every five years. Annually, we review and update the assessment to inform program decision making year-to-year. This includes

reviewing data related to family and child homelessness, income eligibility, and the availability of publicly funded pre-kindergarten programs within the PPS boundaries. The 2025 Early Learners Community Needs Assessment Executive Summary is attached. This report is for the Governing Body's information only. Governing Body approval is not required.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICES

Items listed above are required to be reviewed, updated, and/or approved by the Parent Policy Council and Governing Board.

ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

All items listed above support the high quality, comprehensive wraparound services provided to the children and families attending PPS Head Start.

FISCAL IMPACT

The items included in this packet do not have any significant direct impacts on program or district funding. Some items are required as part of grant agreements (federal, state, and city) in order to maintain current funding.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council reviewed, provided input, and approved these actions/items at spring meetings noted above and reflected in the attached meeting minutes.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION / EVALUATION

The timeline for implementation was the 2024 – 2025 school year.

BOARD OPTIONS WITH ANALYSIS

Board approval needed.

CONNECTION TO BOARD GOALS

The goal of PPS Head Start is to prepare the city's diverse and resilient young children for successful transitions to kindergarten and beyond by leveraging each child's strengths, building their social competence, and developing school readiness skills.

In June 2022, the PPS School Board established a new set of goals. "It remains the core mission and responsibility of our school system to ensure that every student has opportunities to thrive and experience success. Unfortunately, too many students have been historically underserved, and there has not been evidence of racial equity in PPS as revealed by persistent gaps in student outcomes along the lines of race. We are dedicated to the continuous improvements necessary to drive the system shifts that will better support our students, educators, and leaders and result in improved student performance." The Board adopted the following four priorities for the 2022-2027 time period to move the school district toward the above aspirations:

- Improve Third Grade Reading achievement
- Improve Fifth Grade Mathematics achievement
- Improve Eighth Grade Readiness
- Improve High School Graduation rates

The above items support the district's and School Board's vision and priorities.

STAFF RECOMMENDATION

Develop Board resolutions and obtain signatures of approval of the Board Chair of the attached documents.

As a member of the PPS Executive Leadership Team, I have reviewed this staff report.

KJH (Initials)

ATTACHMENTS

A. Policy and Procedures
    a. Safety Practices Policy
    b. Active Supervision Policy
    c. Parent Activities Policy
    d. Classroom Coaching Policy
    e. Fees Policy
    f. Staff Training and Professional Development Policy
B. Policy and Procedures Board Approval Letter
    a. Safety Practices Policy
    b. Active Supervision Policy
    c. Parent Activities Policy
    d. Classroom Coaching Policy
    e. Fees Policy
    f. Staff Training and Professional Development Policy
C. Policy and Procedures Board Resolutions
    a. Safety Practices Policy
    b. Active Supervision Policy
    c. Parent Activities Policy
    d. Classroom Coaching Policy
    e. Fees Policy
    f. Staff Training and Professional Development Policy
D. 2025-2026 Federal Grant Guidance Letter
E. 2025-2026 Federal Grant Renewal Approval Letter
F. 2025-2026 Federal Grant Renewal Board Resolution
G. 2025-2026 PreK Black Excellence Classroom Comprehensive Plan
H. 2025 PPS Early Learners Community Needs Assessment – Executive Summary
I. 4.16.2025 PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council Meeting Minutes
J. 5.14.2025 PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council Meeting Minutes
K. 6.4.2025 PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council Meeting Minutes